



Research that depends on *why* you are asking

- Same company, different purpose
→ different facts: a **sales rep**, a **competitor analyst** and an **interview candidate** need different briefs about Zoho
- Most agents run one generic prompt. Scout turns the purpose into a **playbook-guided plan**, cites every claim, checks its own work, and **learns with use**

Replay of recorded run 20260927-155410-bc87, recorded 2026-09-27 15:54:10+05:30

Goal: We sell a campus hiring-challenge platform. Research Zoho as a prospect and tell us how to pitch.

Cold start: no stored facts about Zoho yet.

intake: done recall: done plan: done execute: done synthesize: done verify: done reflect: done

Plan · Sales prospect

done	1. What is Zoho's overall company size, headquarters location, and global office footprint?
unknown	2. How many university recruitment programs, campus hiring events, or graduate-entry roles does Zoho run annually, and which campuses are targeted?
done	3. What talent acquisition tools, assessment platforms, or hiring-challenge solutions does Zoho currently use or mention in its tech stack?
unknown	4. Who are the senior decision-makers responsible for campus recruiting, talent acquisition, or early-career hiring at Zoho (roles only, not names)?
unknown	5. What recent news, product launches, funding rounds, or strategic initiatives has Zoho announced that could create a buying signal for a campus hiring-challenge platform?

Trace

> Step 1 · done · 2 tool calls · critic: complete
> Step 2 · unknown · 1 tool call · critic: unknown
> Step 3 · done · 3 tool calls · critic: complete
> Step 4 · unknown · 3 tool calls · critic: unknown
> Step 5 · unknown · critic: unknown
> Run events (7)

Score	Tool calls	LLM calls	Tokens	Seconds	Citation coverage	Memory steps	Provider switches
Fit 70/100	9	35	38,866	172.8 s	100%	0	3

Brief

Zoho – Campus Hiring-Challenge Platform Pitch

Purpose: Sales prospect · Run 20260927-155410-bc87

Score: Fit 70/100

- Large global workforce and active campus recruitment indicate strong need for scalable assessment solutions.
- Existing integration with HackerEarth shows openness to third-party platforms.
- Internal assessment tools and unclear decision-maker landscape reduce immediate urgency.

Key takeaways

- Their existing recruitment stack (Zoho Recruit) integrates with HackerEarth assessments, showing openness to third-party testing tools and a need for scalable campus-hiring solutions. [1][2]
- Key risk is that Zoho already has in-house assessment features and no publicly identified senior owners of campus hiring, which may slow adoption and decision-making. [3][4]

Snapshot

- The company operates in more than 80 countries with offices and data centers across Asia, Europe, and the United States. [5]
- Zoho runs its own applicant tracking system, Zoho Recruit, which supports candidate sourcing, workflow automation, and pre-screening assessments. [1][3]
- Zoho explicitly defines and engages in campus recruitment as a hiring channel. [6]

Architecture

Hand-written state machine (no framework). The orchestrator is a generator of events → CLI, UI and trace all consume the same stream.

Intake → Recall → Plan → [Execute ⇌ Critique]* → Synthesize → Verify → Reflect

Layer	Choice
LLM	OpenAI-compatible wrapper, JSON + Pydantic + 1 repair; router across 3 Groq models + Gemini (free tiers)
Tools	Tavily → DuckDuckGo search, SSRF-guarded fetch (httpx + trafilatura), <code>recall_memory</code>
Memory	SQLite: facts, source scores, lessons, feedback, runs
UI	Typer + Rich CLI, Streamlit with live runs and replay

Agentic patterns in action

- **Plan-and-Execute**: purpose-shaped plan from playbook + lessons
- **ReAct** per step: think → search / fetch / recall → observe → cited findings
- **Critic routing**: complete · **retry** (new approach) · **follow-up** (replan) · unknown
- **Verifier**: citations must exist; **numbers must appear in a cited snippet**; 1 revision, then Unknowns
- **Reflexion**: lessons written after each run, voted on later

Step 2 · retried → unknown · 6 tool calls · critic: retry (new approach: Search for "Zoho engineering blog database MySQL...")

What is Zoho's current technology stack for its core SaaS products (programming languages, frameworks, databases, cloud infrastructure, and CI/CD tools) as described in official engineering blogs or reputable tech articles?

I need to find Zoho's technology stack from official engineering blogs or reputable tech articles. Let me search for this information.

```
web_search(query='Zoho technology stack programming languages frameworks databases engineering blog', max_results=8)
```

5 results

The search results are mostly generic tech stack articles, not Zoho-specific engineering content. Let me search more specifically for Zoho's engineering blog or tech articles about their actual stack.

```
web_search(query='Zoho engineering blog "Java" OR "Python" OR "Go" OR "Kotlin" technology stack data centers CI/CD', max_results=8)
```

5 results

The search results are mostly generic tech-stack articles, not Zoho-specific engineering content. The ZDNET article and the Smartmates article look most promising for Zoho-specific stack details. Let me fetch the ZDNET article which discusses Zoho's full stack and infrastructure.

```
fetch_page(url='https://www.zdnet.com/article/zoho-full-stack-operating-system-and-data-protector', focus='Zoho technology stack, programming languages, frameworks, databases, cloud infrastructure, data centers, CI/CD')
```

1973 chars: To Zoho, this is how to deliver a seamless and end-to-end user experience (UX). Zoho is as much a cloud software company as it is a technolo

The ZDNET article confirms Zoho owns its data centers and builds all software in-house, but doesn't list specific languages/frameworks. The Tech Magify page mentions React, Python, Flutter, Node.js. I have enough from the search snippets and the fetched page to compile findings, though specific CI/CD tools and database names weren't explicitly confirmed in these sources. I'll report what's verifie...

Critic: retry — The executor failed to identify the primary backend language (Java) and specific CI/CD tools, relying on a low-quality aggregator (TechMagify) and a general news article instead of Zoho's official engineering blog or reputable technical deep-dives. | sources: <https://catalyst.zoho.com/why-catalyst.html> useless, <https://www.techmagify.com/technology-landscape.php> useless, <https://www...>

Retry with new approach: Search specifically for 'Zoho engineering blog Java' or 'Zoho backend technology stack Java Spring' and fetch pages from zoho.com/insights or zoho.com/blog that discuss their engineering practices, as Zoho is famously a Java-centric shop.

Search for Zoho's engineering blog or tech articles discussing their backend technology stack, specifically Java and 3 related frameworks.

Learns with use: run 2 → run 4

Same question twice ("Prep me for an SDE intern interview at Zoho"):

	tool calls	LLM calls	tokens	seconds	facts reused
run 2	12	31	40,040	203.7	6
run 4	8	22	30,478	99.1	12

- **Same company, new purpose** (run 1 sales → run 2 interview): memory answered Zoho's basics; the plan researched new questions
- **New company, lessons applied** (run 3 Freshworks): 2 lessons written by run 1 shaped the plan
- Fact memory (7 d / 2 d) · source scores $(u+1)/(u+x+2)$ · Reflexion lessons

Compare plans

Plan A

20260927-155410-bc87 · Sales prospect · Zoho

Sales prospect · Zoho

We sell a campus hiring-challenge platform. Research Zoho as a prospect and tell us how to pitch.

1. What is Zoho's overall company size, headquarters location, and global office footprint?

2. How many university recruitment programs, campus hiring events, or graduate-entry roles does Zoho run annually, and which campuses are targeted?

3. What talent acquisition tools, assessment platforms, or hiring-challenge solutions does Zoho currently use or mention in its tech stack?

4. Who are the senior decision-makers responsible for campus recruiting, talent acquisition, or early-career hiring at Zoho (roles only, not names)?

5. What recent news, product launches, funding rounds, or strategic initiatives has Zoho announced that could create a buying signal for a campus hiring-challenge platform?

Plan B

20260927-163916-c8fa · Interview prep · Zoho

Interview prep · Zoho

Prep me for an SDE intern interview at Zoho.

1. What are Zoho's documented recruitment process details, pre-screening assessment tools, and campus hiring approach relevant to SDE intern candidates? 🔥 from memory

2. What is Zoho's current technology stack for its core SaaS products (programming languages, frameworks, databases, cloud infrastructure, and CI/CD tools) as described in official engineering blogs or reputable tech articles?

3. What major news about Zoho has been published in the last 12 months (product launches, acquisitions, funding, partnerships, or engineering initiatives) from press releases or reputable tech news sites?

4. What does Zoho's engineering culture emphasize (e.g., development methodology, open-source contributions, internal tooling, remote work policy, learning programs) according to its engineering blog, developer portal, or employee testimonials?

5. What topics and question formats are commonly reported by recent candidates for Zoho SDE intern interviews (coding platforms used, problem types, system design depth, language focus)?

Results and next steps

- **Evals** (13 recorded runs with the verifier): 100% citation coverage; 24 claims flagged, 7 moved to Unknowns instead of published
- **Safety**: untrusted-content wrapping, SSRF guard, roles only (no profiles or contact data), budgets that end in honest partial briefs, traced provider failover
- **Quality**: 258 offline tests; replayable runs; zero-key example replays and Insights

Next: scheduled competitor tracking · vector memory · parallel steps · Scout as an MCP server

Repo: github.com/UditSinghChauhan/scout-agent (README → quickstart in 5 commands) · MIT